

Initial application Scientific Use File

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Institution

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Project description

Project title

Wealth, Migration & Retirement Sustainability in Germany: Dynamic Microsimulation and Econometric Policy Analysis (2025–2070)

Project framework

internal research

Brief description of project objectives, project content, and analysis methods

Project Objectives and Scope

This research project examines pension accumulation under Germany's statutory pension insurance system (Gesetzliche Rentenversicherung, GRV) and the risk of inadequate retirement income. It examines differences in pension accumulation across population groups and employment biographies, using German-born workers as a reference group.

The analysis focuses on:

- German-born workers as a baseline reference group.
- Workers with migration backgrounds, where identifiable in the available data.
- Migrants and refugees, where relevant characteristics can be identified using the available pension data and complementary research sources.
- Gender differences in pension accumulation, including the role of credited child-rearing periods where recorded.
- Workers with low earnings or interrupted contribution histories and their potential risk of inadequate statutory pension income.

Content and Analysis Methods

- Longitudinal analysis of individual pension insurance biographies, including recorded contribution periods, earnings points (Entgeltpunkte) and credited periods, subject to variable availability.
- Comparison of pension accumulation patterns across available demographic and employment-history groups.
- Dynamic microsimulation of future statutory pension entitlements, calibrated and validated against observed pension histories and clearly stated assumptions about future employment and contribution patterns.
- Scenario analysis of retirement-income adequacy and the potential role of the Grundrentenzuschlag under § 76g SGB VI, subject to the availability of the necessary variables and applicable eligibility rules.

The pension insurance data will be analyzed separately from the other datasets requested for this project. Findings will be compared with complementary evidence on migration, employment, wealth and household circumstances from other research sources. The project does not assume that individual records can be linked

across institutions. Observed pension histories will be distinguished from simulated future outcomes.

Example of what would be the target of the project: <https://retirementgermany.netlify.app/>

What added value does the pension insurance data have compared to other available data?

Longitudinal pension insurance data are necessary to examine how statutory pension entitlements accumulate over individual insurance biographies. Published aggregate statistics alone do not provide enough detail to analyze recorded contribution histories and credited periods over time.

Subject to the availability of the requested data product and its variables, the pension records are needed to:

1. Examine recorded contribution and credited periods and interruptions in pension insurance biographies.
2. Analyze the distribution and development of earnings points and pension entitlements across the available groups.
3. Investigate the contribution of recorded child-rearing and other credited periods to pension accumulation, where identifiable.
4. Calibrate and validate a microsimulation model of statutory pension entitlements under alternative employment and contribution scenarios.

These data will provide the project's pension-specific empirical foundation. We will analyze other datasets independently to examine migration, labor-market outcomes, wealth, and household circumstances. We will compare their findings at an appropriate aggregate or subgroup level, without assuming individual-level linkage between institutions.

We will maintain the distinction between observed pension records and modeled future outcomes throughout the analysis. Any subgroup analysis or eligibility assessment that cannot be directly supported by the available pension variables will be identified as a limitation or modeled transparently.

Start of project

15.10.2026

Planned end of project

30.11.2026

Data products

Data format

STATA (.dta)

Analysis software

PYTHON

Off-Site data products

- Versichertenkontenstichprobe (VSKT 2019)
- Versichertenkontenstichprobe (VSKT 2020)
- Versichertenkontenstichprobe (VSKT 2021)